

# Apple TV+

## *Enters the Global Game*

A Comprehensive Sport Management Plan  
for Breaking Into Cricket & Formula 1 World Markets

---

STUDENT

Dhyey Pandya

PROGRAM

MS in Sport Management

ENTITY

Apple TV+ (Technology /  
Streaming)

YEAR

March 2026

# What We Will Cover

01

## Phase 1 - Entity & SWOT Analysis

Identifying Apple TV+, its current landscape, and strategic opportunity

02

## Phase 2A - Sport Marketing Plan

Segmentation, targeting, personas, and campaign tactics

03

## Phase 2B - Sport Media Management

Three-phase content and media strategy across platforms

04

## Phase 2C - Sponsorship in Sport

ICC Cricket and Formula 1 partnership strategy

05

## Phase 2D - Financial Management

Investment plan, projected revenue, and ROI

06

## Phase 3 - Evaluation

KPIs, measurement framework, and reporting timeline

# Apple TV+

## *The Professional Sport Entity*

### What Is Apple TV+?

Apple TV+ is Apple's subscription-based streaming service, launched in November 2019 and operating in 100+ countries. It competes with Netflix, Amazon Prime Video, and Disney+ on premium scripted content.

In 2023, Apple made its first major live sports move by signing MLS Season Pass, a landmark deal proving Apple can execute in live sports. However, the two largest global sports audiences, cricket (2.5 billion fans) and Formula 1 (700 million followers) remain untouched by any premium US streaming platform.

This plan addresses that opportunity.

**~35M**

Active Subscribers (Est. 2024)

**100+**

Countries of Operation

**2.2B**

Apple Devices in Active Use

**\$250M/yr**

MLS Season Pass Deal Value

# S.W.O.T. Analysis

## STRENGTHS

- 2.2 billion active Apple devices, built-in distribution
- Proven live sport streaming via MLS Season Pass (2023)
- Premium brand aligned with aspirational sport audiences
- Deep capital reserves for rights acquisition
- Global Apple One bundle as subscriber upsell tool

## OPPORTUNITIES

- ICC Cricket: 2.5B fans, near-zero premium streaming in US/UK
- F1 media rights available in key markets from 2026
- 5M+ South Asian diaspora in North America underserved
- Gen Z global sport audience migrating to streaming-native platforms
- Apple Vision Pro, next frontier of sport immersion

## WEAKNESSES

- ~35M subscribers vs Netflix's 280M+, limited base
- No credibility in cricket or motorsport media markets
- Premium price point limits mass-market penetration
- Limited live sport production team outside MLS
- Geo-restricted features tied to Apple hardware ecosystem

## THREATS

- Amazon Prime Video aggressively acquiring global sport rights
- DAZN entrenched in F1 rights across Europe and Canada
- Disney+ / Hotstar dominant in South Asian cricket markets
- Rights inflation, F1 and ICC deals increasingly expensive
- Consumer fatigue from multiple sport subscriptions

# Strategic Opportunity

## IDENTIFIED OPPORTUNITY

Apple TV+ should enter global sport through a dual-sport rights strategy, securing ICC Cricket World Cup streaming rights in North America & the UK, and partnering with select Formula 1 Grand Prix weekends as the premium streaming window, targeting the underserved South Asian diaspora and the Gen Z F1 fanbase with no premium streaming home in the US.

## MEASURABLE GOALS

- |                                                                               |                                                                                      |                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>01</b> Grow Apple TV+ subscribers by 20% within 18 months of rights launch | <b>02</b> Reach 2 million new South Asian diaspora viewers across US, UK, and Canada | <b>03</b> Secure F1 streaming rights in a minimum of 3 key markets by 2026 |
| <b>04</b> Increase Apple One bundle conversions sport-acquired subscribers    | <b>05</b> Generate \$110M+ net positive return on \$480M three-year investment       |                                                                            |

# Segmentation & Target Audiences

## SEGMENT 01

### The Diaspora Fan

#### Ages 22–40 · South Asian Heritage

College-educated, mid-to-high income. Grew up watching cricket. Underserved by existing streaming options in the US.

#### KEY PLATFORMS

Instagram, YouTube, WhatsApp, X

#### TACTICS

Multilingual commentary, Apple Store watch parties, Apple One cricket bundle, cultural tie-ins.

#### TARGET PERSONA

"Ron," 29, Software Engineer, Houston TX. Watches IPL on his phone. Would pay for reliable cricket streaming on Apple TV.

## SEGMENT 02

### The F1 Convert

#### Ages 18–34 · Drive to Survive Generation

Discovered F1 through Netflix. Treats racing like prestige TV — drama, drivers, tech. Deep in Apple's device ecosystem.

#### KEY PLATFORMS

TikTok, Instagram, Reddit, YouTube

#### TACTICS

Director's Mode, Apple Original F1 series, spatial audio, driver-run social content.

#### TARGET PERSONA

"Maya," 24, Marketing Coordinator, Chicago. Discovered F1 in 2020. Finds ESPN dry. Wants storytelling + live racing.

## SEGMENT 03

### The Sport Investor

#### Ages 35–55 · Affluent Apple Power Users

Senior professionals on Apple One. Attend major sport events annually. Value premium exclusivity and tech integration.

#### KEY PLATFORMS

LinkedIn, YouTube, Podcasts, Email

#### TACTICS

VIP hospitality bundles, Vision Pro sport experiences, Apple flagship screenings, AmEx perks.

#### TARGET PERSONA

"David," 47 — MD at Financial Firm, New York. Attends one F1 GP per year. Apple One Family. Wants sport + hospitality as one package.

# Marketing Tactics by Segment

## Segment 1 — Diaspora Fan

- TikTok & Instagram Reels: Highlight reels timed to morning commutes in diaspora cities (Houston, Toronto, London)
- Apple Store Cricket Watch Parties: ICC knockout matches screened in flagship stores, free to attend, Apple TV+ trial required
- Multilingual commentary options: Hindi, Urdu, Tamil broadcast tracks at launch
- Diwali / cultural moment marketing campaigns: co-produced with South Asian

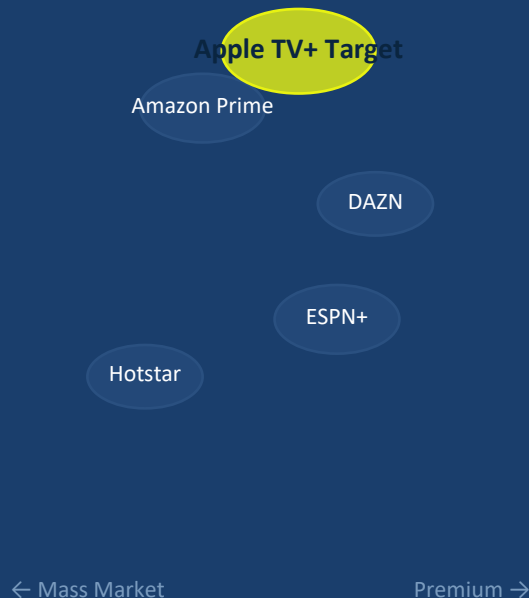
## Segment 2 — F1 Convert

- Director's Mode broadcasts: choose your camera angle, commentary style, or raw team radio feed
- Apple Original docuseries: embedded access to F1 teams across a full season (Drive to Survive format, Apple production quality)
- Game-day social: driver pregame walks, pit crew reels, real-time fastest lap notifications pushed to Apple Watch

## Segment 3 — Sport Investor

- VIP hospitality packages bundled with Apple TV+ Sport tier subscriptions
- Apple Vision Pro 'Pitside' experience: spatial 3D cricket ground / F1 circuit on Vision Pro
- Apple flagship private screening events: invitation-only, paired with Apple One Family upsell
- Co-branded experience packages with Amex Centurion / premium travel partners

## MARKET POSITIONING



# Three-Phase Media Strategy

**2.5B**

Cricket Fans Globally

**700M**

F1 Followers Worldwide

**5M+**

South Asian Diaspora  
in US & Canada

**+40%**

F1 Audience Growth  
Since 2018

## Phase I

Months 1–6

Foundation - Build credibility before rights land. Launch Apple Original docuseries. Seed fan community. Announce rights deals with simultaneous press events in Mumbai, London, and New York.

## Phase II

Months 7–18

Live Launch - Go live with ICC and F1 streaming. Director's Mode broadcasts, Apple Intelligence real-time highlights, Apple Store match day events in 20 flagship cities. Vision Pro sport experiences.

## Phase III

Months 19–24

Loyalty - Retain subscribers in the off-season. Season retrospective Apple Originals, 4K archive, Apple Sport Passport loyalty layer, fan prediction games and sweepstakes.



# Content Strategy & Posting Plan

## Original Docuseries

*"The Last Over" (Cricket)*

*"Grid Life" (F1)*

Apple Original 10-episode series embedded with national teams/F1 teams. Drops mid-tournament to drive live match viewership. The show is the marketing campaign.

## Director's Mode

*Live Broadcast Innovation*

Viewers choose: traditional commentary, stat-heavy data overlay, or raw team radio. Apple differentiates on HOW the game is watched, not just that it's live.

## Real-Time Highlights

*Apple Intelligence Powered*

Auto-generated highlight clips posted within 90 seconds of key moments - sixes, wickets, fastest laps, overtakes. Timed for morning commute viewing across time zones.

## Apple Sport Passport

*Loyalty & Gamification*

In-app layer tracking matches watched, unlocking badges, and earning exclusive behind-the-scenes content. Gamify retention without a separate app.

**TikTok:**

3–5  
videos/week

**Instagram:**

5–6  
posts/week

**Twitter/X:**

7–10  
posts/week

**YouTube:**

2 long-  
form/month

**Match  
days:**

+3× standard  
volume

# Partnership Strategy

PARTNERSHIP 01

## Apple TV+ × ICC Cricket

Exclusive streaming rights for ICC Men's and Women's Cricket World Cups in North America, UK, and Australia. Targeting two of the most-watched sporting events on earth in markets where premium streaming has barely scratched the surface.

|                   |                                                 |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Partnership Type  | Exclusive streaming rights + presenting sponsor |
| Markets           | USA, UK, Canada, Australia                      |
| Duration          | 4-year deal (2 World Cup cycles)                |
| Est. Rights Fee   | \$180–250M over 4 years                         |
| Subscriber Impact | +8–12M subscribers over deal period             |

PARTNERSHIP 02

## Apple TV+ × Formula 1

Select F1 Grand Prix streaming rights focused on 5–8 races per season in markets where Apple TV+ has strong device penetration but F1 lacks a premium digital home. Complemented by an Apple Original documentary series produced in partnership with F1.

|                  |                                         |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Partnership Type | Select race streaming + Original series |
| Focus Races      | Miami, COTA, Las Vegas GP (US-first)    |
| Duration         | 3 seasons with renewal option           |
| Est. Rights Fee  | \$80–130M over 3 years                  |
| Target Audience  | +4–6M subscribers, 60% aged 18–34       |

# Brand Alignment & Creative Activation

## ICC Brand Alignment

- ICC's stated priority: grow cricket in non-traditional markets — Apple operates in exactly those markets
- South Asian diaspora in US is fastest-growing immigrant demographic by income — Apple's core consumer
- Apple has existing global relationships with national broadcasters, simplifying rights licensing
- Women's cricket fastest-growing segment — Apple Original on ICC Women's WC is first-mover opportunity

## F1 Brand Alignment

- F1's audience is among the most tech-forward in professional sport — iPhone users, AirPods owners, MacBook users
- Winning an F1 fan to Apple TV+ is an ecosystem reinforcement — these users upgrade annually and subscribe to Apple One
- Three US Grand Prix give domestic launch moments and appointment viewing windows each season
- Drive to Survive proved that narrative-driven sport content builds passionate new fan communities from scratch

## CREATIVE ACTIVATION

### *"The Last Over"* **Apple Original Series**

10-episode series embedded with two national teams through a full ICC tournament. Episodes drop mid-tournament, building narrative momentum that drives live match viewership. The show IS the marketing campaign.

---

### *"Grid Life"* **Apple Original F1 Series**

Season-long embedded access to two F1 teams. Spatial audio and Vision Pro companion experience for episode drops. Launches before Season 2 of rights period to build brand momentum.

Enhanced fan engagement via premium tech

Broadened reach into diaspora & Gen Z fanbases

Apple One bundle conversion driver

Content IP with global licensing potential

Hardware ecosystem reinforcement

# Investment Plan & Revenue Projections

3-YEAR INVESTMENT BREAKDOWN

|                                         |        |
|-----------------------------------------|--------|
| ICC Streaming Rights (amortized Yr 1–3) | \$150M |
| F1 Select Race Rights (3yr)             | \$110M |
| Apple Original Productions (3 series)   | \$90M  |
| Marketing & Brand Campaign              | \$60M  |
| Production Infrastructure & Technology  | \$40M  |
| Apple Store Event Activations           | \$18M  |
| Influencer & Creator Partnerships       | \$12M  |
| TOTAL INVESTMENT                        | \$480M |

PROJECTED NET 3-YEAR RETURN

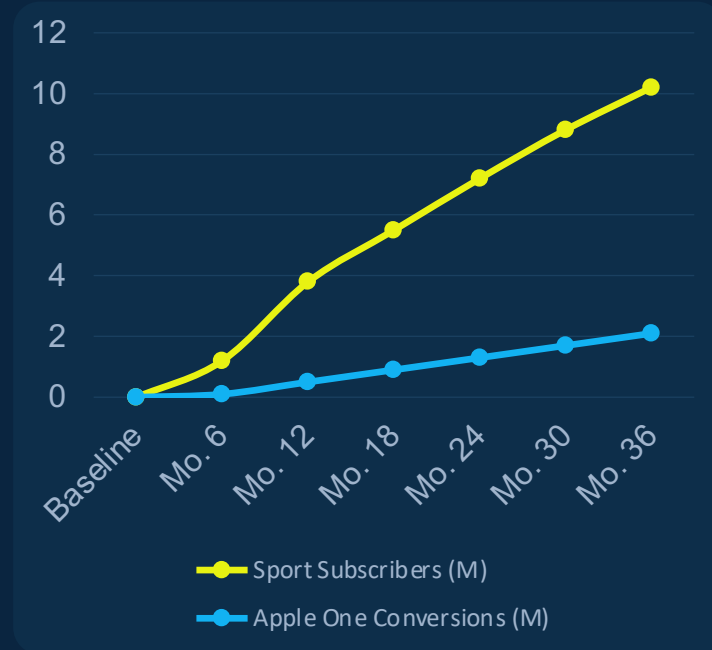
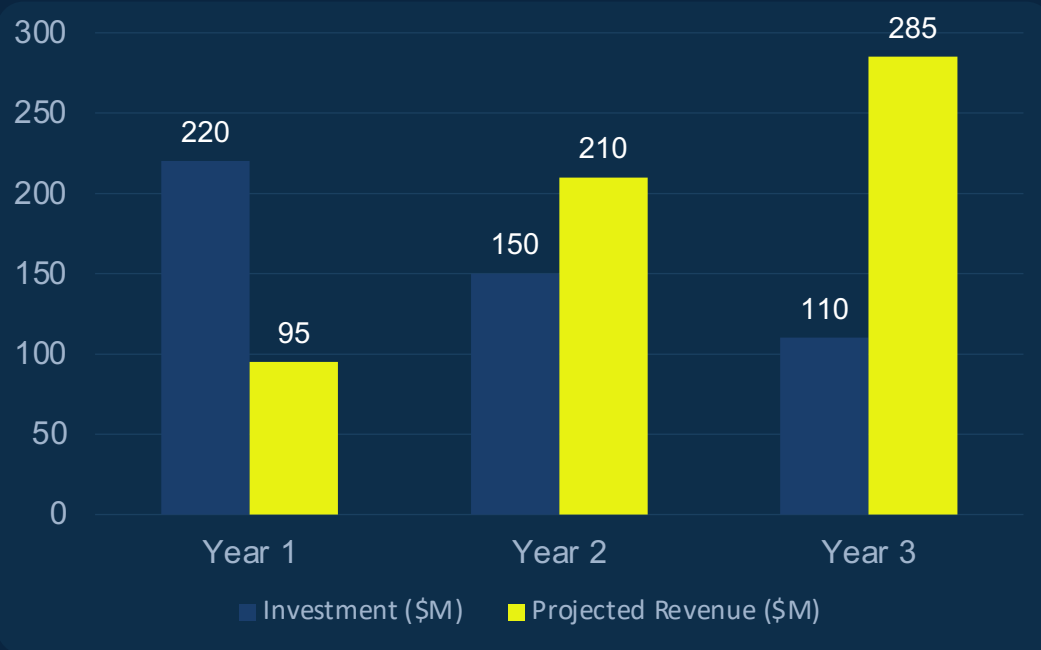
**+\$110M**

PROJECTED REVENUE RETURNS

|                                                |        |
|------------------------------------------------|--------|
| New subscriber revenue (10M × \$9.99/mo × 3yr) | \$360M |
| Apple One bundle upsell conversions (est.)     | \$95M  |
| Advertising revenue (select markets)           | \$40M  |
| Hardware lift (Apple TV device purchases)      | \$55M  |
| Hospitality / VIP co-revenue                   | \$22M  |
| Licensing of Apple Originals                   | \$18M  |
| TOTAL PROJECTED REVENUE                        | \$590M |

Excluding brand equity, hardware ecosystem value, and subscriber LTV uplift — Apple's internal models suggest actual return could be 3–5× this figure.

# Year-by-Year ROI Analysis



## KEY ASSUMPTIONS:

· 10M new subscribers over 3 years

· Avg. retention: 24+ months per sport subscriber

· Apple One upsell rate: ~15%

· Hardware lift estimated conservatively

# Measuring Plan Effectiveness

## KPIs - Sport Marketing

- Net new subscribers attributed to sport rights (target: +10M in 3yr)
- Apple TV+ app download rank in target markets during match weeks
- Apple Store watch party attendance (target: 50K+ per major event)
- Brand awareness shift among South Asian diaspora and F1 fans pre/post
- Apple One bundle conversion rate from sport subscribers (target: 15%+)

## KPIs - Sponsorship

- ICC broadcast unique viewers per tournament in target markets
- Brand sentiment: Apple TV+ sport perception in cricket and F1 communities
- Earned media value from rights announcements and documentary releases
- Co-branded revenue from ICC/F1 hospitality partnership packages
- Partnership renewal intent score from ICC and F1 executives at 24-month mark

## KPIs - Sport Media

- Concurrent stream count on ICC and F1 match days (target: 500K+ per flagship event)
- Social media follower growth across Apple TV+ sport accounts (+40% in 12 months)
- Apple Original series completion rate (target: 65%+ episodes completed)
- Post-match highlight clip engagement - reach, saves, shares within 2 hours
- Subscriber churn rate for sport-acquired subscribers (target: <3% monthly)

## KPIs - Financial

- Revenue vs investment ratio quarterly - tracking toward \$110M net target
- Subscriber LTV for sport-acquired vs organic subscribers
- Hardware lift measurement: Apple TV device sales in rights launch markets
- Apple One conversion revenue from sport subscriber base
- Cost per subscriber acquisition vs retention - sport tier vs baseline

# Reporting Timeline & Review Cadence

| Monthly                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Quarterly                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Post-Event                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Annual                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Social analytics dashboard review</li><li>• Subscriber acquisition by channel</li><li>• Streaming concurrency reports per event</li><li>• Churn rate monitoring by segment</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Fan engagement survey (500+ respondents per market)</li><li>• Apple One bundle conversion review</li><li>• Cost per acquisition vs retention analysis</li><li>• Competitor rights and content benchmarking</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Full tournament / season debrief</li><li>• ROI report per rights package</li><li>• Stakeholder sentiment: ICC and F1 partnership teams</li><li>• Content performance: completion rates, social lift</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Comprehensive plan vs goals assessment</li><li>• Rights renewal or expansion decision</li><li>• Subscriber LTV 3-year cohort analysis</li><li>• Board-level financial performance review</li></ul> |

# The global game has a new home.

*Apple TV+ × Cricket × Formula 1*

---

Dhyey Pandya · MS in Sport Management

## Thank You